

task (34%). Implies that performance was most proportionally impaired in the least perceptually challenging condition and least impaired in the most perceptually challenging condition. These data implicate an abnormality in the efficient control of attention. Further studies are needed to determine if the schizophrenia attentional control deficit is due to an impairment detecting likely target candidates during search or to inefficient search caused by working memory impairments that result in repeated visits to previously searched locations.

The sensory gating phenomenon has also been studied using a strategy that measures a subjects response to a starting response such as a loud noise. Study was conducted by Braff et al. (1990) which focused on the reduction in the startle response that is associated with the presentation of a prestartle stimulus (e.g. a softer noise) that occurs 30 to 150 msec before the starting response. It was found that patient's schizophrenia tend to have a reduction in the response to the louder sound when a prepulse was presented.

Uhlhass et al. (2005) evaluated deficits in visual perceptual organization in schizophrenia over the course of inpatient treatment, in relation to the remission of particular psychotic symptoms. Disorganized (n=14) and non disorganized (n=33) schizophrenia patients were tested upon admission to an inpatient psychiatric unit, and again after 3 weeks of treatment, on two measures of visual perceptual organization. Performance of schizophrenia patients was compared to group of patients with psychotic disorders other than schizophrenia (n=19) and non psychotic psychiatric disorders (n=25). Symptom ratings were collected at both assessment points. Deficits in visual perceptual organization were observed for both tasks in disorganized schizophrenia patients at index and these deficits improved during the course of treatment. Moreover, improvement in visual perceptual organization correlated